Usability Report: Employee Onboarding

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Summary

Work Performed
This document follows the first round of the usability testing for Employee Onboarding at https://garage-boilerplate-basic-frontend-andfu1v21-praise-the-fool.vercel.app/
This is intended to perform a follow-up testing and to compare changes against the first round, as well as to gather additional feedback.

The purpose of performing usability testing is to help understand how the target users interact with the product, and the problems that arise from the process of using and navigating the webpage. To improve and refine our website, qualitative, moderated, remote testing was performed; to understand where and why users struggle and what needs to improve.

The testing was performed to answer the following questions:

- Can new employees sign in intuitively, either with email/password or Google?
- Are error states easily understandable?
- Does the tour effectively communicate everything that the employee needs to know?
- Do users understand what they need to complete?
- Can the participant find the Assistant, via both the sidebar and Home page link?

Findings / Conclusion
From the tests, some findings were brought to attention:

- Overall layout felt typical for a company app
- Participant was able to sign in intuitively with their email
- The error states were easily understandable
- The tour was helpful with navigating the webpage, as it was direct and short
- The participant understood what was needed to be completed, as the participant stated “having just the checklist is straightforward”
- The participant was able to easily find the assistant, especially since it was introduced to them in the tour

Areas to improve (Ranked by Severity)

1. The tour doesn’t go through the updated components on the assistant page
2. Sign out button doesn’t ask for confirmation before signing out

3. The tour box in the assistant page blocks the new chat button, as well as the query when the participant is prompted to try asking one
4. Components such as sign out and profile have no hover tooltips (e.g. hovering over sign out shows a tooltip for “Sign out”)
5. The help section doesn’t clearly indicate that it’s meant for the tour

Comparison to Round 1

- Overall, the participant appeared to find the webpage easier to browse compared to the participant in round 1
- The participant appreciated being able to go through the tour again, as they wanted a bit more clarification on what the components were for
- The profile page has better detail now

Next Steps & Recommendations

1. Update the tour to explain the new components (new button, chat history, pausing query)
2. Update the sign out flow to ask for user confirmation
3. Ensure that the tour box doesn’t block new components on the assistant page
4. Add hover tooltips for necessary components (Sign-out, profile, etc)
5. Update the help section to make it clear that it’s for the tour

Test Assessment

Objective
The objective of this test is to run target users through the webpage's features, to gather information on their understanding and intuition on using it.

Participant
Testing was conducted with an individual who meets at least one of the criterias:

- Has completed an onboarding process
- Has used an AI chat assistant or chatbot before
- Is comfortable using web apps on a desktop
- Currently work in office environment

Participant 01:
Asked to stay anonymous, currently an office worker who has also gone through an onboarding process in their company.

Materials
The testing was conducted by providing the participant with a link to the vercel deployment of the application, with temporary login details provided to them to test with.

Procedure:

1. Participant was asked to access the webpage via the link given
2. Participant incrementally work through tasks as the facilitator asks
3. Facilitator observes each task and notes down participant's behaviour
4. After all tasks are completed, the facilitator asks participant for their overall opinion and comments, and proceeds to ask questions from a pre-defined list.

Results
Usability testing was conducted remotely and moderated with one participant. Participant shared their screen and completed tasks in order as directed by the facilitator. Facilitator noted down behaviour and thoughts, as well as feedback from the participant. Then, the post-task questions were asked.

In summary, the design was typical for a company onboarding application. Compared to the first round, there was no complaints about feedback, especially for when the assistant was processing queries. The participant appreciated being able to look at their chat history and being able to view more details on the tasks. Although it was minor, there were also a few changes that the participant had recommended.

Test Session Checklist for the Facilitator

- Create a test account for the participant to use
- Join a call with the participant
- Introduce and explain the testing process
- Explain the setup and what the participant needs to have prepared
- Request user to share their screen
- Have user complete tasks as defined, following facilitator requests
    - Facilitator takes notes as user navigates the webpage
- Ask user if they have any questions
- Ask user questions from the list

Tasks to perform

- Create a new account, through email or google (This will be deleted after the session)
- Wait for Facilitator's word to continue
- Attempt to log in with invalid details, then log in with the provided details.
- Participate in the tour
- When prompted, ask the assistant about your tasks
- Find out what tasks you need to complete
- If you're unsure about any tasks, try asking for help
- Once again, ask the assistant anything about your tasks
- Return to homepage and verify the tasks are the same

Post-Task Questions

1. Was the tour helpful with navigating the webpage?
2. Was anything confusing or unexpected?
3. Was there anything you expected to see but didn't?
4. Was there anything that was unclear, whether it be wording, labels, or buttons?
5. Did the page give you enough feedback about what was happening?
6. How did the layout and design feel?
7. Is there anything you would change? Was there anything you didn't like design wise?
8. Is there anything you would recommend?

Answers for Post-Task Questions

1. **Was the tour helpful with navigating the webpage?**
    - It was helpful with navigating the webpage
    - It directly tells you everything you need about the webpage
2. **Was anything confusing or unexpected?**
    - Unexpected that the tour allows you to go through specific sections (Dashboard, AI assistant), expected for a single option to go through the entire tour
    - The box in the tour of the assistant page should move, did not realize that the new chat button was there because the tour box was blocking it.
    - Tour should be updated to explain the new components in the assistant chat page
    - Tour did not go through the profile page either
    - Sign out button “instantly kicks you out”, without asking for confirmation “are you sure you want to log out?”
3. **Was there anything you expected to see but didn’t?**
    - Nothing really expected
4. **Was there anything that was unclear, whether it be wording, labels, or buttons?**
    - The “Help” section doesn’t clearly indicate that it is the tour, it was a bit confusing.
    - Expected the tour to be in the header, next to the profile or underneath “Help”
5. **Did the page give you enough feedback about what was happening?**
    - The page gives enough feedback about what happened
6. **How did the layout and design feel?**
    - It’s typical of a company onboarding app, “you’d want it to be as straightforward as possible”, “having just the checklist is straightforward, it’s good”
7. **Is there anything you would change? Was there anything you didn’t like design wise?**
    - Components should have hover tooltips upon hovering a mouse over them.
8. **Is there anything you would recommend?**
    - “Very important, ‘are you sure you want to log out’ question upon clicking the log out button”